What Can Mom Do on Her Own? A Family Observation Worksheet

Write down what you've seen this week, not what you assume.

“She needs help” is a feeling. “She needed two reminders to take her pills on Tuesday” is an observation, and observations are what a professional can use.

Fill this in over several days, not in one sitting. Write what you saw, with the day. If you haven't seen something, write “haven't seen” and leave it.

In her own words

Ask Mom what she feels she can do and where a hand would be useful. Write what she says, the way she says it.

FOR EXAMPLE “I can shower fine. I just don't like doing it when nobody's home.”

What she does on her own

Bathing, dressing, using the bathroom, eating, moving between bed and chair, getting around the house. Only what someone has seen this week.

FOR EXAMPLE Tuesday: dressed herself, took about twenty minutes. Sat down to put on her shoes.

What she does with help, and who helps

The help that's already happening, including the small things people have stopped noticing.

FOR EXAMPLE Pills: Karen fills the box on Sundays. Mom takes them herself, I think. Haven't checked.

What has changed since the hospital

Anything different from before the stay, written as what you saw.

FOR EXAMPLE Used the stairs every day before. Hasn't gone upstairs since she came home.

What nobody has seen

The parts of her day no one in the family has watched. Don't guess.

FOR EXAMPLE Nobody has been there at night. We don't know how she gets to the bathroom.

Who filled this in, and on which days

What this shows you

Three things: what you've seen, where help already happens, and what nobody has looked at yet. It doesn't show how much care Mom needs. Nothing here adds up to a score or a level, and the clinical questions, such as medications, therapy or anything that worries you, go to the people who assess her.

Ready for the next step?

You've written down what you've seen instead of what you assumed. The care interview picks up from there: it walks you through Mom's situation area by area so nothing important is overlooked, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›